SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #1 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

"There will never be enough."

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Where it often comes from

Growing up with real shortage, hearing worry about bills at the table, going without, or living through a layoff or a lean season can teach the body to expect "not enough." Even after things improve, the alarm can keep ringing. Constant messages to buy more, have more, and keep up can also make any amount feel small.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not pretend that need is unreal. It records hunger, drought, and poverty. But it consistently teaches that God knows what we need and provides, often day by day. Israel gathered manna and found there was enough for each person. Jesus told us not to be consumed with worry about food and clothing, because our Father knows. These passages do not promise riches, and they do not say a person in need has done something wrong. They invite trust, wise stewardship, and the use of the help God provides through work, family, church, and community.

> *"And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus"* (Philippians 4:19).

Also see

> "The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want" (Psalm 23:1).

> "Therefore do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added unto you" (Matthew 6:31–33).

> "When they measured it by the omer, he who gathered much had no excess, and he who gathered little had no shortfall. Each one gathered as much as he needed to eat" (Exodus 16:18).

> "And God is able to make all grace abound to you, so that in all things, at all times, having all that you need, you will abound in every good work" (2 Corinthians 9:8).

Common self-statements

- No matter what I earn, it will not be enough.
- There is always another bill around the corner.
- If I relax, I will run out.
- Other people have enough; I never do.
- I cannot enjoy anything because I might need the money later.
- Good times never last.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always run short.
- Catastrophizing: Treating every unexpected expense as the start of ruin.
- Mental filter: Noticing what is missing and overlooking what I do have.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that if I am not fully secure, I am completely without.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I need right now, and is it covered today?
- When have I feared running out and then found that a need was met?
- What would "enough" look like in numbers, and have I ever written it down?
- Where did I first learn to expect that there would never be enough?
- Is this a present shortage, or an old alarm that has not shut off?
- What is one small step I can take this week toward wise planning?

Truth summary

> Some seasons are hard, and some needs are real. But "never enough" is a prediction, not a fact. God knows what I need and has met my needs before. I can plan wisely, accept help, and take one day at a time, trusting the One who provides.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Money
- Poverty
- Riches, True
- Anxiety/Worry
- God, All Powerful

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's repeated gifts and new mercies express His continuing love.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "There will never be enough"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"There will never be enough." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I actually need today?
- ☐ When has a need been met after I worried?
- ☐ What would "enough" look like in real numbers?
- ☐ Is this a present shortage or an old alarm?
- ☐ What small step can I take this week?
- ☐ Who could I ask for help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I have what I need for today.
- ☐ Planning is wise; panic is not.
- ☐ God has met my needs before and I can trust Him again.
- ☐ Enough does not have to mean plenty.
- ☐ I can ask for help without shame.
- ☐ I can be thankful and prepared at the same time.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Philippians 4:19**
  "And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ **Psalm 23:1**
  "The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want."
- ☐ **Matthew 6:31–33**
  "Therefore do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added unto you."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I had and what I needed: Each evening, write one need that was met today and one worry about tomorrow. Note whether the worry came true.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Philippians 4:19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My God will supply what I need, and I can take one wise step today.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Riches, True" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write a simple "enough" list. List what you need monthly for food, housing, and transportation. Compare it with what you have. Note any gap honestly.
- [ ] Name three needs God has met in the past. Write them down. Read the list when worry rises.
- [ ] Make one small, realistic plan. Choose one step, such as a short budget, a call to a creditor, or setting aside a small amount, and do it this week.
- [ ] Practice thanks. At each meal this week, name one thing you have. Notice whether the feeling of scarcity changes even a little.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "There will never be enough": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A need that was met
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~There will never be enough.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know what I need before I ask. Quiet the alarm inside me that says there will never be enough. Help me plan wisely, receive help, and trust You for today. Thank You that You provide. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.